FIRST MIDTERM MOCK EXAM - SAMPLE 6

a) Read the text carefully and complete the blanks. For blanks 1 to 5, choose the right verb form. For blanks 6 to 10, choose the right connector. (3 points each) **_____/30**

Penicillin

The antibiotic properties of penicillin [1] **was discovered / were discovered / discovered** by biologist Sir Alexander Fleming in 1928, but this revolutionary event [2] **occur / had occurred / occurred** because Sir Fleming had a nasty trait: He [3] **was not / were not / had not been** tidy and he usually [4] **left / had left / was left** his lab without cleaning it. This time was not the exception: Fleming [5] **fails / had failed / was failed** to clean his laboratory again [6] **so / after / before** he left on a two-week vacation, including petri dishes that contained staphylococci. [7] **Besides / Therefore / However**, he saw that an unusual mold had grown on one of the dishes. [8] **But / What's more / However**, that mold had apparently killed the bacteria. This phenomenon was not new for him [9] **before / so / as** he had previously discovered the antibacterial enzyme lysozyme by chance. [10] **After / Therefore / Before** he let his nose drip into a petri dish, he noticed that the liquid killed the bacteria growing in the dish. An act of genius or grossness?

Glossary: nasty: desagradable grossness: grosería let: permitir, dejar drip: gotear

b) Make Wh- Questions about the following extract. Underline and number the answers in the extract. (7 points each) **____/35**

Ray Bradbury is considered one of the greatest American writers of science fiction. He began his career in 1943, and three years later, he published his first collection of short stories, *Dark Carnival*. He became a distinguished celebrity after he had written his story cycle, *The Martian Chronicles*. In 1953, Bradbury published his literary masterpiece *Fahrenheit 451*. What's more, by the age of 34, the author had received the National Institute of Arts and Letters Award for contributions to American literature.

1. Who ……?
2. When ……?
3. What ……?
4. ……?
5. ……?

c) Express yourself: Choose *ONE* of the topics below and write a 4-sentence paragraph. Include at least two elements from each column below. **_____/35**

…enjoy…	*therefore*
…find it… to	*as*
…good at…	*after*
…I am a/an …	*however*

1. What is the role of serendipity in scientific discoveries?
2. What are you like? What are your skills and qualities? What are your weak points?

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EXAM SCORE:			……/100
96-100 points= 10	76-85 points= 8	66-69 points= 6	50-55 points= 4
86-95 points= 9	70-75 points= 7	56-65 points= 5	0-49 points= 2

KEY

Exercise A - 30 points

1. were discovered
2. occurred
3. was not
4. left
5. had failed
6. before
7. However
8. What's more
9. as
10. After

Exercise B - 35 points

(Sample answers. There may be other possibilities.)

[1] Ray Bradbury is considered one of the greatest American writers of science fiction. He began his career [2] in 1943, and three years later, he published [3] his first collection of short stories, Dark Carnival. He became a distinguished celebrity after he had written his story cycle, The Martian Chronicles. In 1953, [4] Bradbury published his literary masterpiece Fahrenheit 451. What's more, by the age of 34, the author had received [5] the National Institute of Arts and Letters Award for contributions to American literature.

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1. Who is considered one of the greatest American writers of science fiction?
2. When did he begin his career?
3. What did he publish three years later?
4. Who published the literary masterpiece Fahrenheit 451?
5. What had the author received by the age of 34?

Exercise C - 35 points

Students' own answers.